## 8.2.1 Natural Calamities

### Flood

When excess of water overflows, it submerges land and destroys everything that get in its way. This is called flood. Flood usually caused when the volume of water with in a lake, river, or other body of water exceeds the total capacity of the body. Sometimes level rise and causes it overflow its channel.







Floods are the most common natural disaster in India

### What to do before hand

While town planning it is the government's responsibility, individuals should find about risks in the area where they are living e.g. people who live in areas down stream from a dam should know the special signals when a dam threatens to break. Forecasting of floods or tidal waves is very difficult, but hurricanes and cyclones often occur at the same time of the year when particular vigilance must be exercised. They are often announced several hours or days before they arrive.

## 8.2.2 During Flood

- Turn off the electricity to reduce the risk of electrocution.
- Protect people and property (as soon as the flood begins, take the vulnerable group, children, the old, sick and the disabled to an upper floor)
- Whenever possible, move personal belonging upstairs or go to raised shelters provided for use in floods.
- Beware of water contamination if the taste, colour or smell of the water is suspicious. It is vital to use some means of purification.
- Evacuate denser zones as ordered by the local authorities.

### After a flood

When a flood is over, it is important, people do not return home until that told by local authorities, who will have ensured that buildings have not been undermined by water. From then on it is essential to;

- Wait until the water is declared safe before drinking.
- Clean and disinfect any room that has been flooded.
- Sterilize or wash with boiling water all dishes and kitchen utensils.
- Get rid of any food that has been in or near the water including canned foods and any food kept in refrigerators and freezers.
- Get rid of all consumables (drinks, medicines, cosmetics, etc.,)

## 8.2.3 Earthquakes





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